Newspapers

H 1920

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A. Background

General newspapers that have no topical focus are not cataloged and classified at the Library of Congress. Individual newspapers that deal with a specific topic or ethnic group were cataloged as part of the U.S. Newspaper Program (USNP). The USNP was succeeded by the National Digital Newspaper Program (NDNP), which is a project to create a national digital resource of historically significant newspapers published between 1690 and 1963, from all the states and U.S. jurisdictions. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for the assignment of subject headings to individual newspapers that were cataloged in the USNP as well as to works about newspapers of this type.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign

Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on assigning LCGFT to newspapers, including those on special topics, see the LCGFT Manual J243.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Newspapers: a serial publication that contains news on current events of special or general interest, the individual parts of which are listed chronologically and appear usually at least once a week.

Ethnic newspapers: primarily intended for a specific ethnic audience. It may deal with a wide range of news topics of interest to the group and not be limited to any specific subject matter. It may also focus on events and activities occurring within the ethnic community on a local, national, and/or international level.

D. Topical newspapers

To an individual newspaper on a specific topic, assign headings of the type ***[topic]--[place]*** (if appropriate) with the free-floating form subdivision ***--Newspapers*** as the final element of the heading, for example, ***Bimetallism--United States--Newspapers***.

LC practice: To an individual newspaper on a specific topic, assign headings of the type ***[topic]--[place]*** (if appropriate). Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Newspapers***.

E. Newspapers about a specific place

To an individual newspaper that contains information about a specific place, assign a heading of the type ***[place]--Newspapers***. Assign this heading only if the newspaper contains substantive information about the place and/or activities occurring in it. Do not assign a heading of this type solely to bring out the place of publication of the newspaper.

LC practice: To an individual newspaper that contains information about a specific place, assign a heading for the place, i.e.***[place]***. Assign this heading only if the newspaper contains substantive information about the place and/or activities occurring in it. Do not assign a heading of this type solely to bring out the place of publication of the newspaper. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Community newspapers***.

F. Newspapers of national and ethnic groups in the U.S.

Assign subject headings to American ethnic newspapers as follows:

F.1. General rule

Assign a heading of the type ***[...] Americans--[local subdivision]--Newspapers***. Use, as the local subdivision, the place where the presence of the group is discussed, i.e. the community served by the newspaper**.**

If an ethnic group cannot be established in the form ***[...] Americans*** because its name is already in composite form (cf. H 1919.5, sec. 2.c), assign the heading in its established form subdividing it by the locality in the United States, for example, ***Russian Germans--Texas--Newspapers***.

LC practice: Assign a heading of the type ***[...] Americans--[local subdivision]***. Use, as the local subdivision, the place where the presence of the group is discussed, i.e. the community served by the newspaper**.** Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Community newspapers***.

Examples

Armenian Americans--California--Los Angeles--Newspapers

Hungarian Americans--Ohio--Cleveland--Newspapers

Hispanic Americans--Southwestern States--Newspapers

Korean Americans--Virginia--Arlington--Newspapers

LC practice:

Subject string: Armenian Americans--California--Los Angeles

Genre/form term: Community newspapers

F.2. Newspapers for North American Indians

The heading ***Indigenous peoples--America*** is used for the native peoples of the United States and Canada collectively, as well as the United States in general. Assign headings to North American Indigenous newspapers as follows:

F.2.a. Particular tribes

For a newspaper of a particular tribe, assign the heading for the tribe with the subdivision ***--Newspapers***, for example, ***Hopi Indians--Newspapers***.

LC practice: Assign a heading for the name of the tribe. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Newspapers***.

F.2.b. Tribes within a region

For a newspaper of a group of tribes within a region, assign the heading ***Indigenous peoples--[Name of region]--Newspapers***, for example, ***Indigenous peoples--Northeastern States--Newspapers***.

LC practice: For a newspaper of a group of tribes within a region, assign the heading ***Indigenous peoples--[Name of region]***. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Newspapers***.

F.2.c. Tribes throughout the United States

For a general newspaper of Indian tribes throughout the United States, assign the heading ***Indigenous peoples--United States--Newspapers***.

LC practice: For a general newspaper of Indigenous peoples throughout the United States, assign the heading ***Indigenous peoples--United States***. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Newspapers***.

G. Works about topical newspapers

To a general work that discusses various newspapers on a specific topic, assign the appropriate topical heading such as ***Journalism, Medical*** or ***Press, Labor***. For bibliographies, directories, union lists, etc., of such newspapers, further subdivide the heading by the appropriate form subdivision, for example, ***Journalism, Mining--Great Britain--Bibliography***.

Do not use the subdivision ***--Newspapers*** with or without further subdivision when cataloging a work about newspapers. The subdivision may be used only as a form subdivision to designate an individual newspaper.

To a work about an individual topical newspaper, assign the authorized access point of the newspaper as a subject heading as well as the appropriate topical heading divided by place.

LC practice: Assign a topical subject heading for the focus of the work. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Bibliographies***.

H. Works about newspapers of national and ethnic groups in the U.S.

To a general work about various newspapers of a particular American ethnic group, assign the appropriate phrase heading such as ***African American newspapers***, ***German American newspapers***, etc. Divide by place if appropriate. Treat these headings as topical headings, i.e. do not use the subdivision ***--History and criticism***. For historical treatments, however, use the subdivision ***--History***.

Example:

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Title: The German immigrant press in Milwaukee.
   650 #0 $a German American newspapers $z Wisconsin $z Milwaukee $x History.
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For bibliographies, directories, union lists, etc., of such newspapers, use the appropriate form subdivision, for example, ***German American newspapers--Bibliography--Union lists***.

To a work about an individual newspaper of an American ethnic group, assign the authorized access point of the newspaper as a subject heading as well as the appropriate phrase heading divided by place, for example, ***Italian American newspapers--Connecticut***.

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.